

Mann Deshi Foundation

Founded: 1988

Sector: Women Empowerment, Financial Inclusion, Rural Livelihoods

Mann Deshi Foundation started in 1992 as Mann Vikas Samajik Sanstha to combat rural poverty in Maharashtra's drought-prone areas. It was formalized in 1996 with the launch of Mann Deshi Mahila Sahakari Bank—the first RBI-licensed rural cooperative bank exclusively for women in India, offering collateral-free loans and financial access.

Founded by **Chetna Gala Sinha** amid Maharashtra's drought-hit regions, Mann Deshi grew from just 20 initial women savers to a robust multi-state network. It tackled deep gender barriers in finance, pioneering collateral-free loans and inclusive banking services for rural women entrepreneurs. By 2023, it had expanded significantly into digital platforms during COVID recovery, emphasizing resilience training, financial literacy, and adaptive business skills.

Service Categories:

Women Empowerment: Delivers financial access via 90,000+ bank accounts, entrepreneurship training boosting incomes by 25-30%, and leadership programs fostering independence and decision-making for rural women entrepreneurs.

Community Development: Strengthens villages through regular health camps, water conservation across 50+ sites, youth sports centers for girls' leadership, and agri-market linkages ensuring sustainable livelihoods.

CORE PROGRAMMES:

Business Schools (Udyogini): 14 stationary + 12 mobile vans serving remote areas; 19 vocational courses (tailoring, goat rearing, agri-business, veterinary); 60% technical skills + financial literacy/marketing; trained 45k+ women, with 27k+ launching/scaling businesses successfully.

Financial Products: Microloans (₹10k-₹5L, collateral-free), pioneering UTI pension fund for rural women, insurance tie-ups; 90k+ accounts opened, 55% repayment rate exceeding industry norms; ₹50cr+ via Social Impact Fund with Northern Arc.

Chambers of Commerce: 13 women-led networks aiding scaling through regulations/licenses, peer mentoring, market linkages; delivered 40% sales boost for members via customized support services.

Holistic Support: Mann Deshi Radio FM (rights/health education); 5 Champions Youth Centres (5k girls in sports/leadership); Farmer Producer Company for agri-value chains; health camps (10k+ screened yearly); water harvesting projects; digital/UPI training for 20k+ women.



WOMEN'S EMPOWERMENT COMMUNITY EMPOWERMENT



MANN DESHI FOUNDATION'S IMPACT ANALYSIS

1st pension fund in partnership with the Unit Trust of India for rural women micro-entrepreneurs in India

25% increase in average annual incomes of business school trainees

55% women felt financially empowered after trainings, 1st Cash Credit product for rural women in weekly markets,

4,00,000 women have participated in women's empowerment programmes

90,000 accounts with the Mann Deshi Sahakari Bank

50,000 people in the community have benefitted from access to clean water

900 farmers have come together in farm to market programmes in the last year

9,000 girls benefited through the bicycle programme to ensure access to schools

2x increase in farmers' incomes because of additional cash crops planted.